

Killer rigs

Build the configuration of your choice; from budget to high-end rigs. We tell you about components that matter

Price watch

Find out prices of the latest ultrabooks and compact cameras to help your buying decision

Buying the right smartphone

Helping you buy a phone, the smart way



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You thought buying a smartphone was easy? Apparently not! The amount of innovation we've seen over the past year has made smartphones not even 12 months old seem archaic. You're constantly acquainted with newer technologies at breakneck speed, especially when it comes to software. Apple's iOS and Google's Android are going at it hammer and tongs. Research in Motion is pulling out all stops trying to make the BlackBerry OS as slick as its rivals. In the meanwhile, Microsoft is betting big on Windows Phone 7.5. Symbian is still around, which just complicates matters for the consumer. I thought I'd make it easy for you to do your homework.

Your choices decide your fate

First off, get a fix on the budget you wish to spend. This will be the first level of shortlisting, making the second and third tasks easier. For a budget of less than ₹10,000, you'll get Android, BlackBerry and Symbian smartphones. Between

₹10,000 and ₹20,000, you'll get the whole host of Android, BlackBerry and Symbian phones, along with a few Windows Phone devices and the good old Apple iPhone 3GS. Beyond ₹20,000, the sky's the limit – you have a choice of high-end devices. Heck, if your budget allows you could even splurge on the phones in the Droolmaal section!

Once you do that, you'll have a fair idea of what's within your reach. Try out various platforms – on a friend's phone, at the nearest retailer, etc. – before narrowing down your choice. Don't go by the recommendations of just anyone, since what someone else may find comfortable may not be very impressive to you.

Below ₹20,000 is where a majority of phones are single core, so you'll have to increase your budget if dual-core is a criteria! You should get an idea of what you'll be using the phone for, which will help pinpoint the general hardware.

Some love touch screens, while some swear by a physical keypad. Which category you fall in depends on you. It's a good idea to experience both device types, and then decide what you're comfortable with. As a general rule, anyone who sends many text messages or emails from the phone will prefer a hardware keypad, all the better if it's QWERTY.

What type are you?

The basic user

If you're anything like my dad and believe that the smartphone is still primarily a phone, with familiarity being a critical criterion, you'd be best suited off with either a Symbian smartphone or a BlackBerry. What you get with both these OSes is a UI (user interface) that's relatively similar to the previous versions, and even the versions before that – for they've been around for donkey's years! And most of these platforms come with devices having



Apple iPhone4